dispatched military forces to tackle the situation. It was in this context that the **Truman Doctrine** was born which constituted a call to resist outside forces which clearly was directed against international communism and, by implication, it pointed at the Soviet Union.

This was soon followed by the Marshall Plan of 5 June 1947. The conditions in Greece and Turkey made it inevitable to preserve Western Europe from the Soviet influence. Around this time, the communists were able to garner support in Europe, especially in countries like Belgium, Greece, Italy and Hungary. In Belgium, Denmark, Norway, the Netherlands and Sweden, the communists were able to mobilize an average of 10 per cent of the vote. Further, the dwindling European national economies led to the instability of these countries. Therefore, to thwart communist subversion and restore stability of European countries by revamping the national economies, the Marshall Plan was announced. The Marshall Plan envisaged the transfer of significant amount of funds to Europe on the assumption that only a massive monetary infusion would allow Europe to resurrect from the ravages of war and stabilize its material condition and political atmosphere. The main line of thinking was that a stable Europe would be able to resist the indigenous and exogenous communists.

The Soviet response to the Marshall Plan was the Molotov Plan of July 1947 which included a series of bilateral agreements linking the Soviet Union with the East European countries. This was the economic response to the Marshall Plan. The political response was the establishment of the Communist Information Bureau (COMINFORM) (September 1947) to provide Moscow with the institutional means to control foreign communist parties.

A year after the execution of the Marshall plan and the creation of COMINFORM, the Soviets had been successful in repressing all undesirable non-communists elements in Hungary, Romania, Bulgaria and Poland. In Czechoslovakia there was a Prague Coup in the end of February, 1948 and installation of a communist government under Clement Gottwald. The fall of Czechoslovakia raised apprehensions in the West European minds of a possible military threat from the Soviet Union. Hurriedly, the Europeans concluded the Pact of Brussels on 17 March 1948. It was a mutual